

Tobias Treppmann

Design leader who never stopped building — prototypes that run against real APIs, and a quality bar the build enforces rather than the review

CONTACT

LOCATION

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA
2022 – 2026

Theological Studies

Theologisches Seminar Rheinland
2003 – 2007

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

ONGOING

Independent Consultant

Oratio&Co

2016 – Present · Remote

Collaborative leadership coaching and product-strategy consulting for mission-driven organizations.

PROFILE

I lead design functions and I still build. At Ninox I ran design and, for four months, product as well: nine people across design, UX writing, product and data science. The last year has been hands-on by choice. I prototype in real code against real production APIs, engineering ships from that code, and around 70% of it reaches production. The quality bar lives in the build. Six checks refuse work that leaves the system, and over a library believed clean they identified 32 off-system values. Craft I can point at, not describe.

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web and connected TV; engineering supplied by an external agency) · Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- I prototype in code, not in specs — real code against real production APIs, web first and then Android. Engineering ships from it. Around 70% of the AI-generated code reaches production directly or with minor modification, and iteration moved from days to hours.
- A quality bar the build enforces — six checks that run identically on a laptop and in CI. Two reject what an AI assistant produces. One is a token reference that does not resolve, the other a color hardcoded into a component. Over a library believed clean they identified 32 off-system values.
- A color engine, and the tool that configures it — k-means clustering in OKLCH rather than RGB, so artwork-driven themes carry even perceptual weight across a grid. Text is validated against base with the WCAG algorithm until the pair passes. Every threshold is a dial rather than a commit.
- UI quality across four surfaces — iOS, Android, web and connected TV, held by DTCG tokens in three tiers that sync live to Figma and Android. One commit propagates everywhere, so the high-quality choice is also the fast one.
- Design decisions made against numbers — conversion and usage metrics analyzed as standing practice, alongside competitive analysis against the global apps entering this market. The differentiation strategy is built on what came back rather than on taste.
- Audit the existing products, then improve them — a full experience audit across the apps, and the redesign that came out of it. Refining the flows people actually use, and taking them through to implementation, because what I hand over is running code.

Head of Product Design · Interim Head of Product

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) · Berlin, Germany

- Two functions at once, nine reports, four disciplines — from July to October 2023 I held Product Design and Product together. Design was five, split between product design and UX writing, including a design lead. Product was three product managers and a data scientist. Senior Leadership Team throughout.
- Hired 2, promoted 2 — including the consultant who then took Head of Product permanently. Coached the design lead through a strained engineering relationship. Ten years mentoring designers alongside the day job, at CareerFoundry and the Interaction Design Foundation.
- Design made co-equal by agreement rather than assertion — a collaborative UX-maturity self-assessment run with product and engineering, after which design held parity in planning. Shared design-system governance across four designers and engineering, with custom motion easing curves carried by the system.
- Prompt-to-database onboarding, with the CEO and technical co-founder (freelance, summer 2025) — the AI-generated schema renders into the real data-model editor rather than a chat preview. People can inspect and correct what the model produced. It became the basis for the public AI beta.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP — ~50 people, DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) · Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- The measured outcome I trust most — a booking capability that cut coordination time by 70% with 90% acceptance at the launch customer. The internal plan was a standalone add-on module. I delivered a capability embedded in the platform instead, and it then shipped to every customer.
- Accessibility past our own front door — we audited the ChurchDesk website and also the websites customers build with the platform, for EU Accessibility Act compliance. Plus AI alt-text generation shipped for EU accessibility compliance across six countries.
- Product management and all of product design at once — across six countries I wrote the specs, ran the ticket board engineering worked from, and was the launch customer's main contact through to delivery.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) · Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Five years of data-dense interfaces — pivot tables, column charts, aggregated JSON views, result cards and filter logic. The hardest was the query-builder preview, where the result is a sample and the interface has to say so without becoming unreadable.
- Research as a habit, not an event — pioneered iterative usertesting.com screening to reach analysts working inside regulated banks and insurers. I defined component behavior and specs across the library, motion included as custom easing curves, and the UI designers executed the visual system.

UX Strategy Lead

2014 – 2016

Spreadshirt (international e-commerce, hundreds of thousands of consumers — 200+ people) · Leipzig, Germany

- Research that changed a consumer product's direction — leadership wanted a 60-second automated journey. Interviews with shop owners found the design process was the part they valued most. The strategy moved to automation that preserves control, and the mobile designer prototype went to production.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

Senior Mentor · *CareerFoundry* · 2016 – 2026 · Remote · a decade reviewing and critiquing designers' work

Product & UX Strategist · *Hypoport hub SE* · 2021 – 2022 · Berlin / Lübeck, Germany

Mentor · *Interaction Design Foundation* · 2020 – 2022 · Remote

UX Manager · *HairDirect* · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, PA, USA

User Experience Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, PA, USA

Web Designer & Front-End Developer · *HOPE International* · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, PA, USA

SKILLS

Hands-On Craft

Prototypes built in real code against real production APIs, web first and then Android, with engineering shipping from that code · Around 70% of the AI-generated code reaches production directly or with minor modification, and iteration moved from days to hours · A color engine live in production, with k-means clustering in OKLCH so artwork-driven themes carry even perceptual weight · Selah — Mindful Transitions: a macOS app designed, built and shipped solo on the Mac App Store

Visual, Interaction and Polish

UI quality owned across iOS, Android, web and connected TV · DTCG tokens in three tiers synced live to Figma and Android, so one commit propagates everywhere · WCAG contrast validated inside the color algorithm rather than checked afterwards, in light and dark · Custom motion easing curves carried by the design system at Ninox and Datameer · Six checks in CI that refuse off-system work, which identified 32 off-system values in a library believed clean

Leading and Coaching Designers

Product Design and Product held together at Ninox from July to October 2023 · Nine reports across four disciplines — product design, UX writing, product management and data science · Senior Leadership Team · Hired two, promoted two · Coached the design lead through a strained engineering relationship · Ten years as a senior mentor at CareerFoundry, reviewing and critiquing designers' work · Two years mentoring at the Interaction Design Foundation

Research and Analytics

Conversion and usage data analyzed as standing practice at Bibel TV · Interviews recorded and analyzed with Claude · Competitive analysis against the global apps entering this market, and the differentiation strategy built on it · Pioneered iterative usertesting.com screening at Datameer to reach analysts working inside regulated banks and insurers · At Spreadshirt, interviews with shop owners moved product strategy away from a 60-second automated journey · The measurable impact I trust most is ChurchDesk's 70% coordination-time reduction and 90% acceptance, and it is workflow efficiency

Product Instinct and Strategy

Interim Head of Product at Ninox with three product managers and a data scientist · Partnered with Hypoport's executive team to productize the service organization of a listed group · At ChurchDesk the internal plan was a standalone add-on module. I delivered an embedded platform capability instead, which cut coordination time by 70% with 90% acceptance at the launch customer · Wrote the specs and ran the ticket board engineering worked from

Working with Product, Engineering and Data Science

A data scientist among the nine reports at Ninox · Design-system governance run as a cross-functional working group with an escalation path · At Bibel TV the handoff crosses a company boundary to an external engineering agency and holds anyway · Claude Code, Claude skills, Cursor and Zed as daily tools · Android/Kotlin, SwiftUI, React and web